USING TORRENTS

What are torrents?

In a single word, torrents are simply 'files' that hold information related to other files and folders that are to be distributed. When you download a movie torrent, this 'torrent file' contains necessary information which will let you get that movie.
In short, when you're 'torrenting' a file, it pretty much means that you are transferring a file over a P2P or Bittorrent network. A P2P network in the simplest explanation means a network that is created when two or more computers are connected to share resources without going through a separate server computer.

NOTE: Torrenting copyright information is illegal, but there are quite a few things you can torrent which are perfectly legal. Downloading torrent software isn't illegal; downloading copyright information without buying that information legally is.

What is included in this document?

1. Downloading torrent software
2. Starting the torrent download

What are some commonly-used free BitTorrent software?

- µTorrent (found at utorrent.com)
- BitTorrent (found at bittorrent.com)
- Vuze (found at vuze.com)
- Tribler (found at tribler.org)

What are some websites with free and legal torrents?

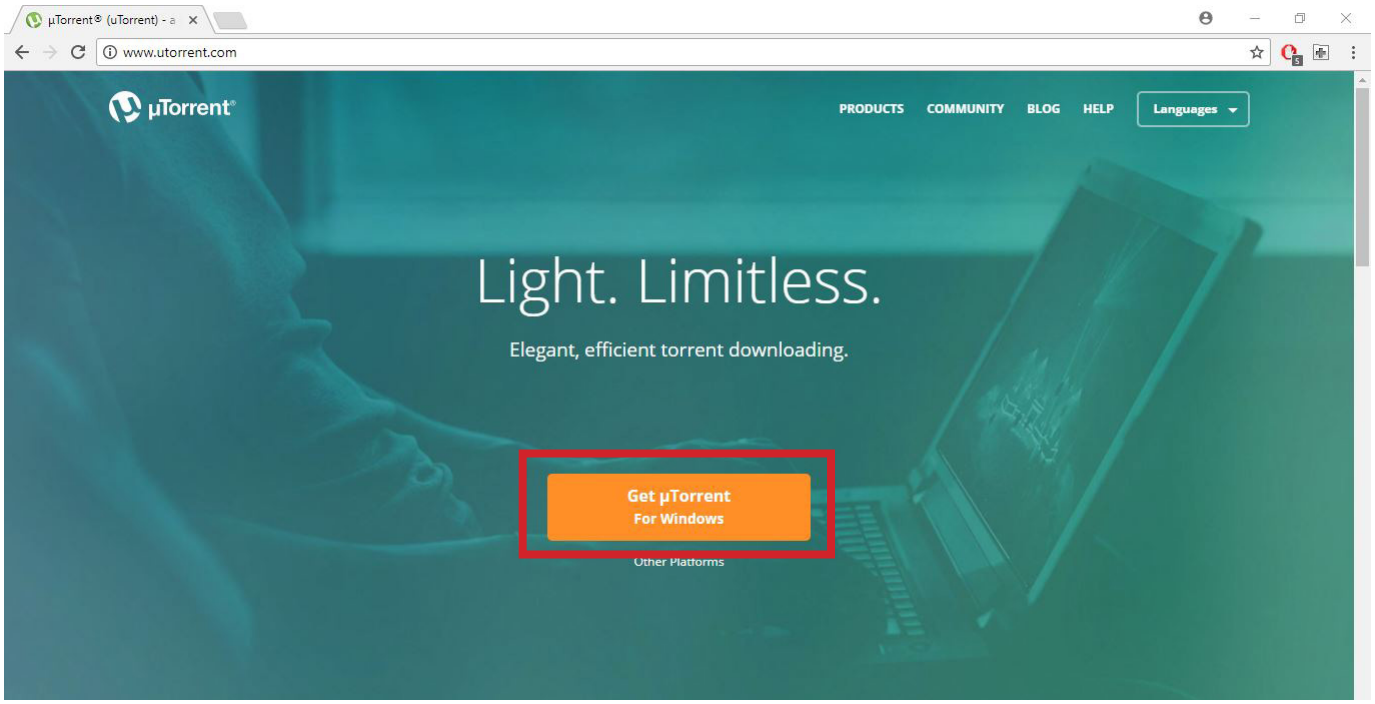
- Public Domain Torrents (found at publicdomaintorrents.info)
- Internet Archive (found at archive.org/details/feature_films)
- Legit Torrents (found at legittorrents.info)
- Vuze StudioHD Network (found at vuze.com/content

The time taken for a torrent to download depends on the amount of seeds and the file size. The higher the peers and leeches on the torrent, the slower your download speed, and the longer the time taken.
SEEDS: People with the complete file that you want to download that are sharing it with you.
PEERS: People like you who are downloading the torrent and have partial files that they are willing to share.
LEECHES: People who are downloading but unwilling to share their partial files with anyone.

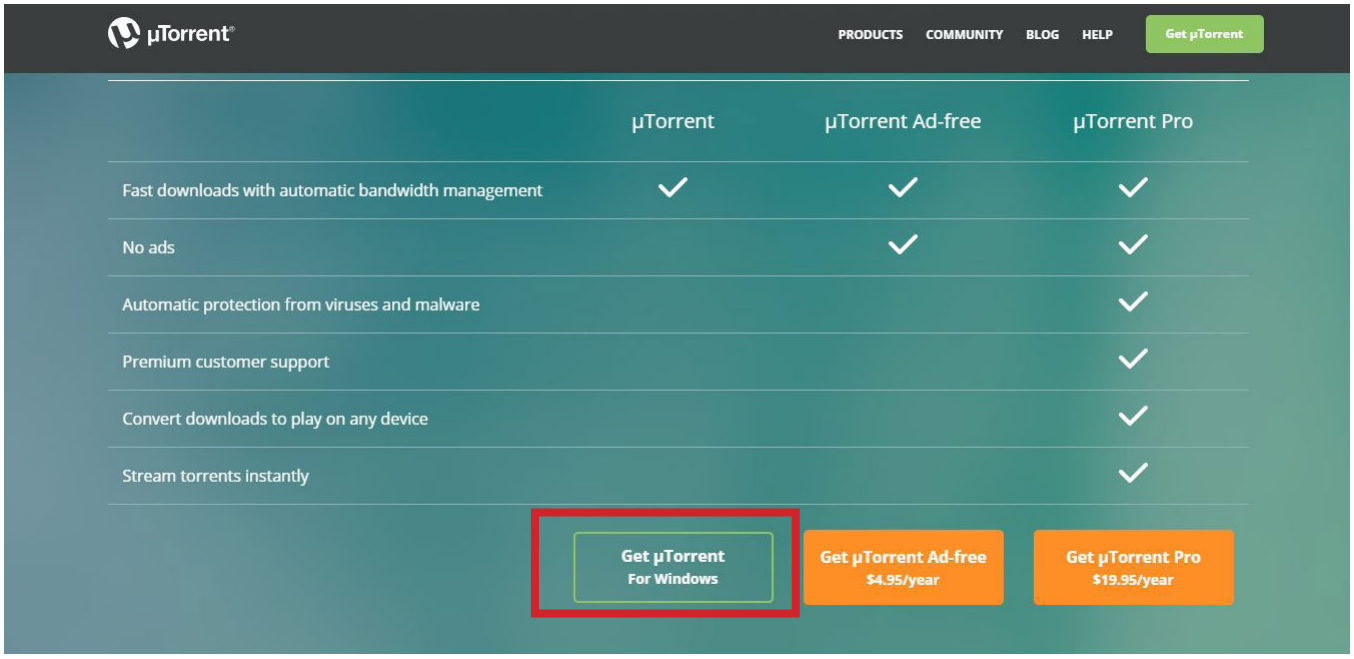
NOTE: For the purposes of this document, we shall only look at the procedure for a Windows machine running Windows X and Google Chrome.

Downloading Torrent Software

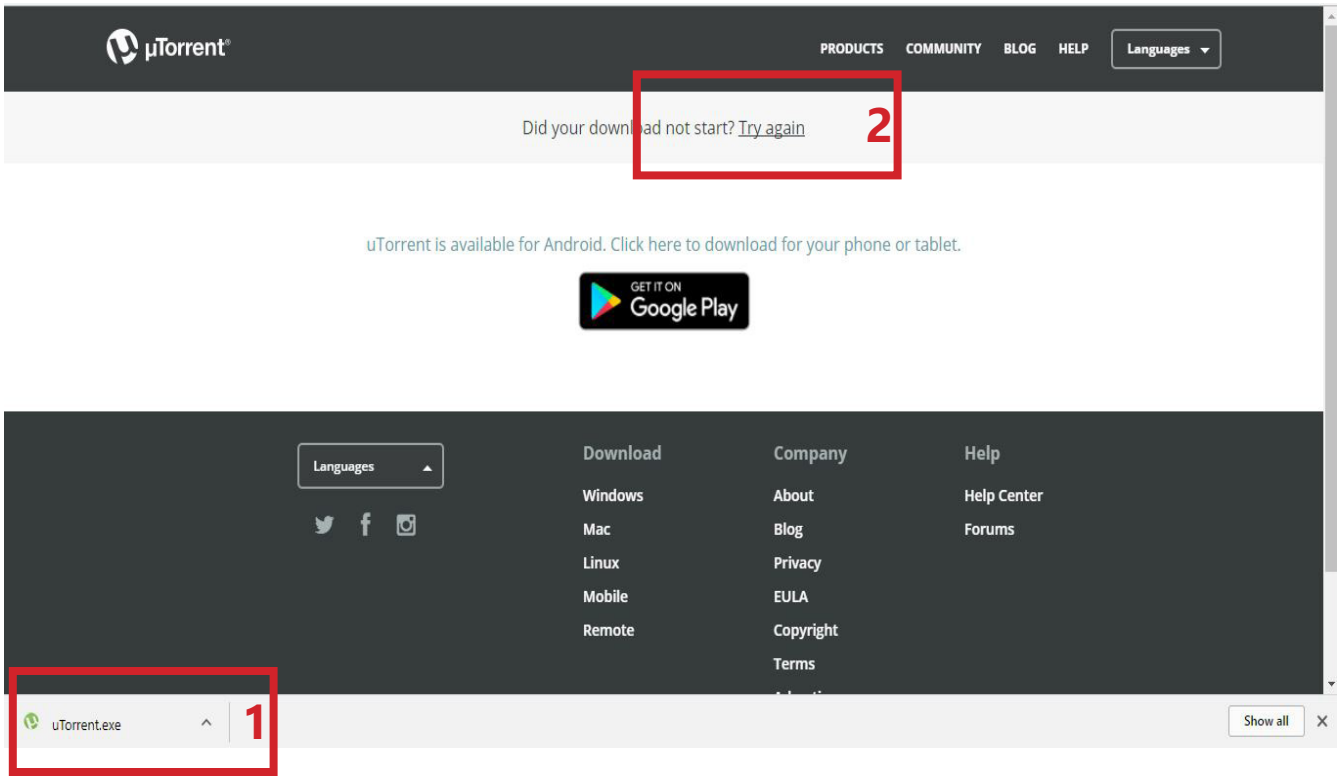
1. Navigate to the website of the torrent software you choose, on the web browser of your choice.. For the purposes of this document, I have navigated to utorrent.com on Google Chrome on a Windows X PC, *as shown below*.



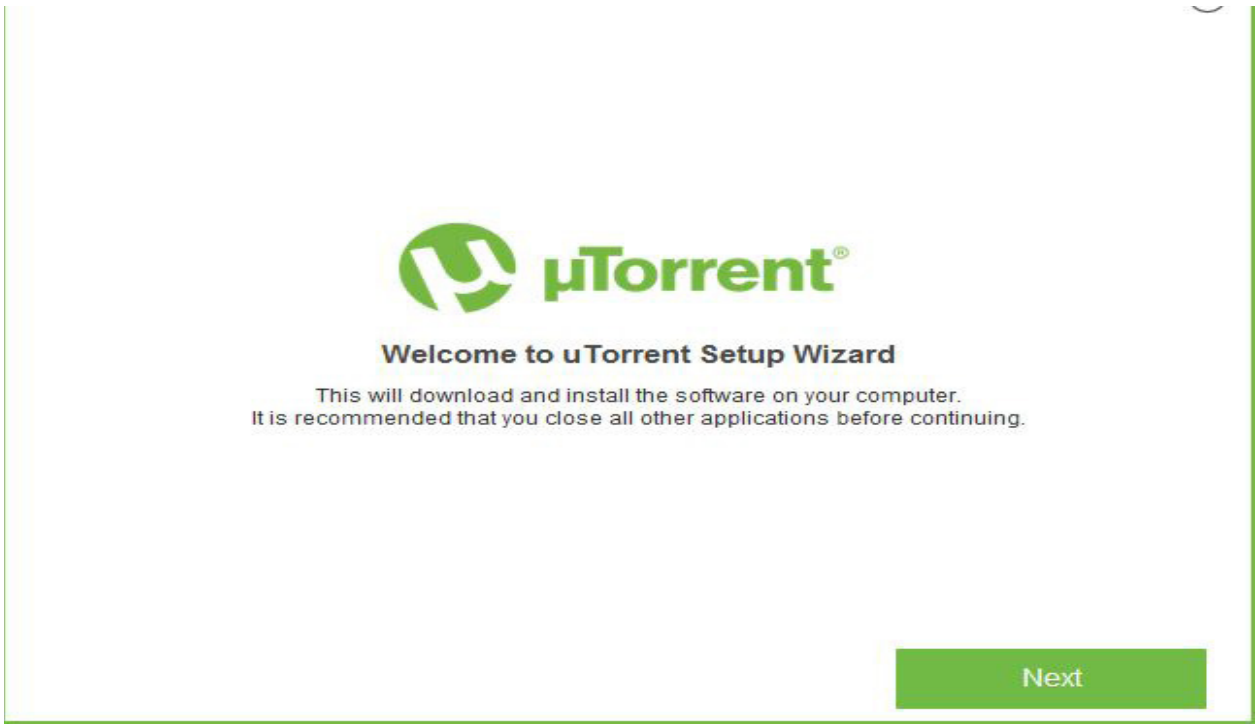
2. Click on the orange **Get uTorrent** button in the center of the screen, if you are using Windows. If you are using a Mac or Linux machine, click on Other Platforms below the orange button.
3. Clicking on the orange button takes you to the screen *shown below*. Click on the **Get uTorrent for Windows** button.



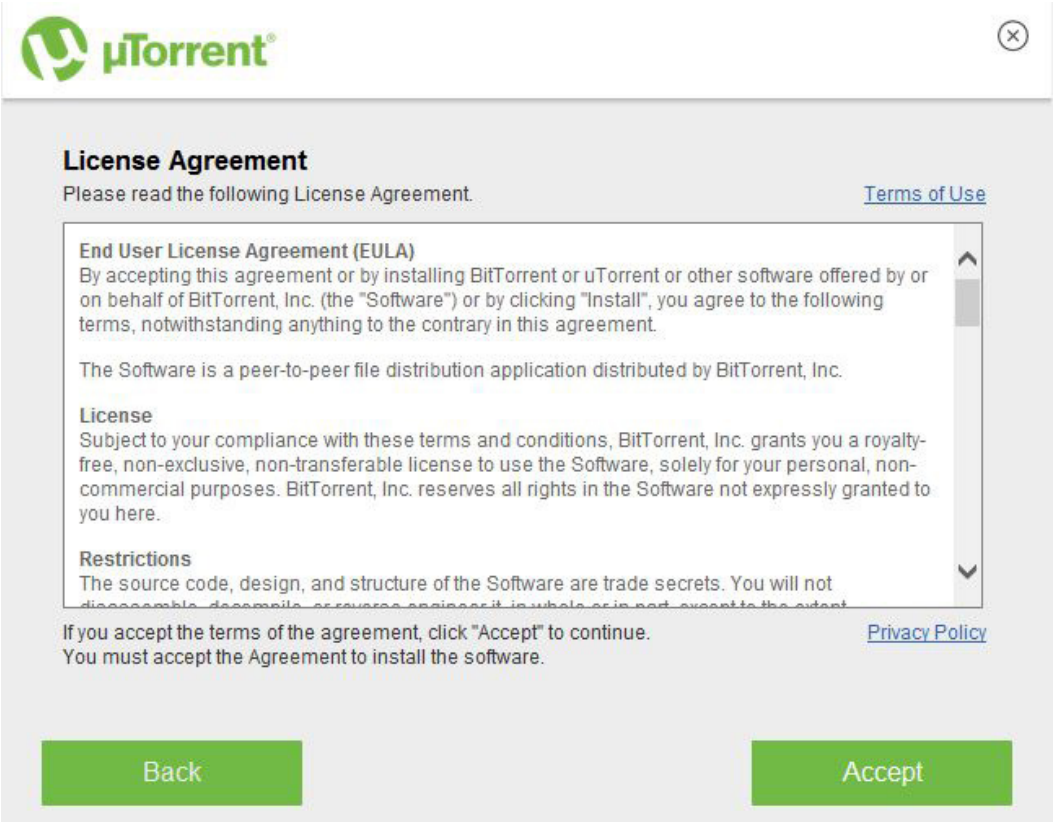
4. The user is redirected to another page, and the download starts automatically, and on Google Chrome, shows on the bottom left corner, *as indicated by the rectangle numbered with 1 below.* If the download doesn't start, click on the underlined **Try Again**, *indicated by the rectangle numbered with a 2, below.*



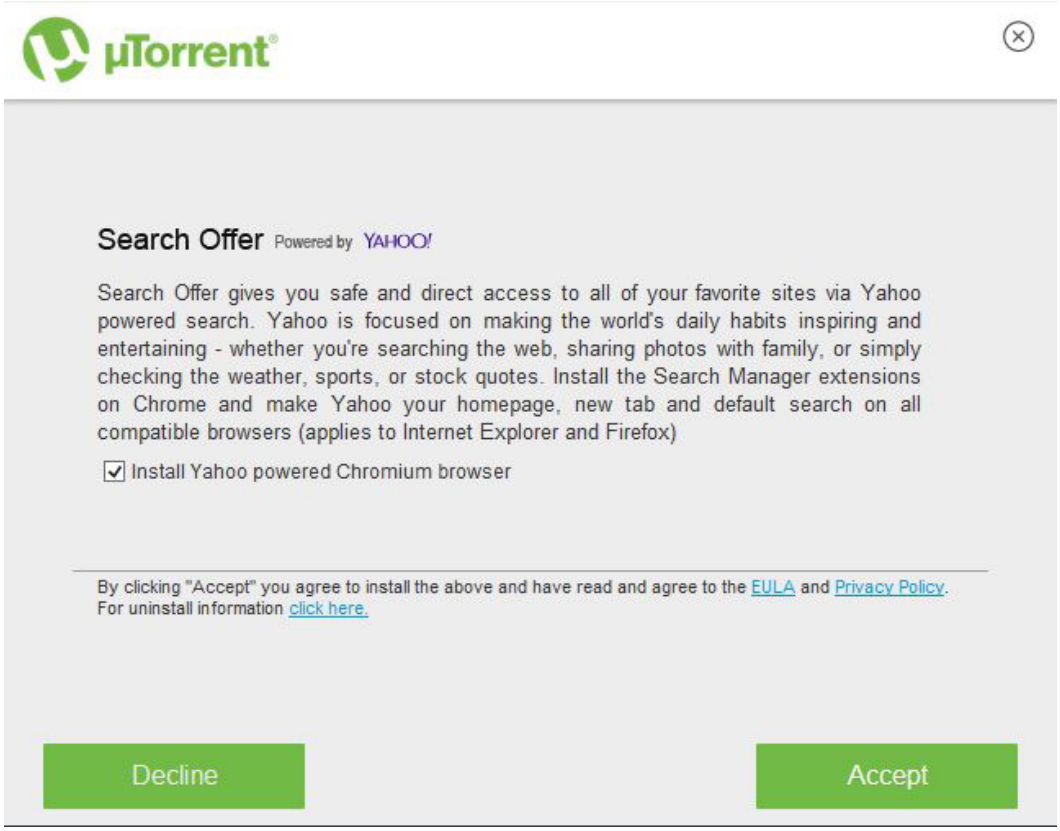
5. You now have the installation file to uTorrent software on your local machine. Click on the Chrome download *indicated by the red rectangle above* to start the installation.
6. If you have any security prompts on your machine, click to approve all of them and you shall be directed to a window that looks like the window *indicated below.* Click on **Next** to start the installation process.



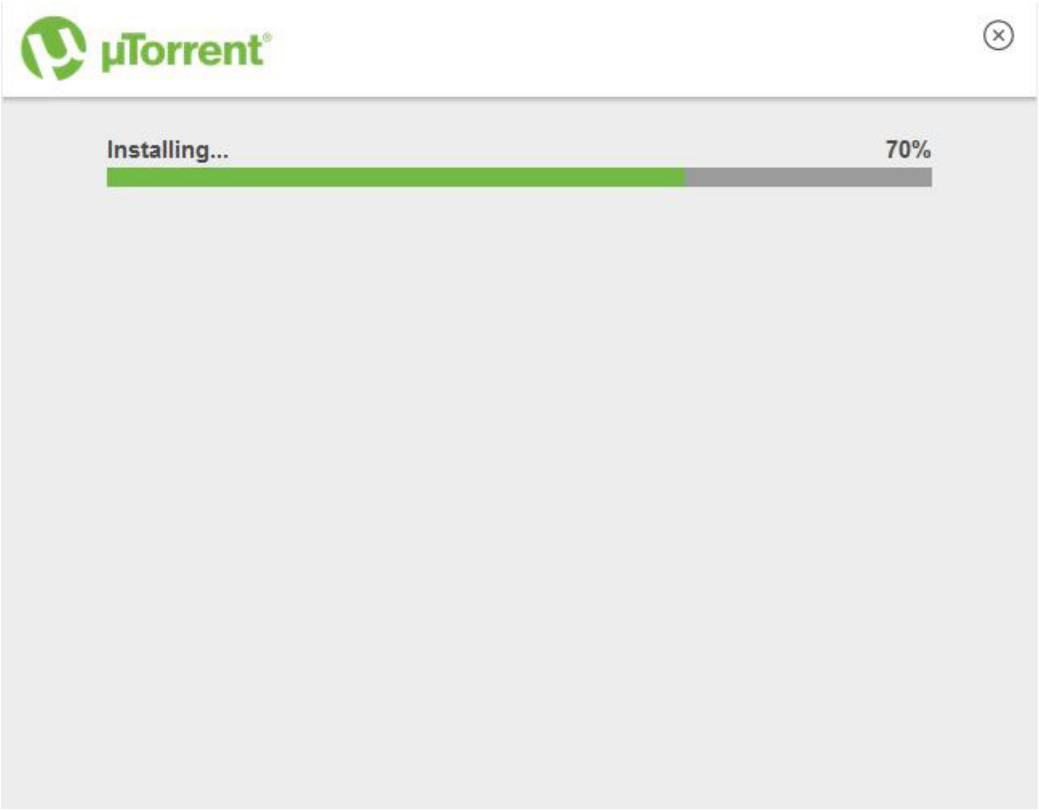
7. Click on **Agree** after you've read the agreement you shall be signing with the company providing you with the software.



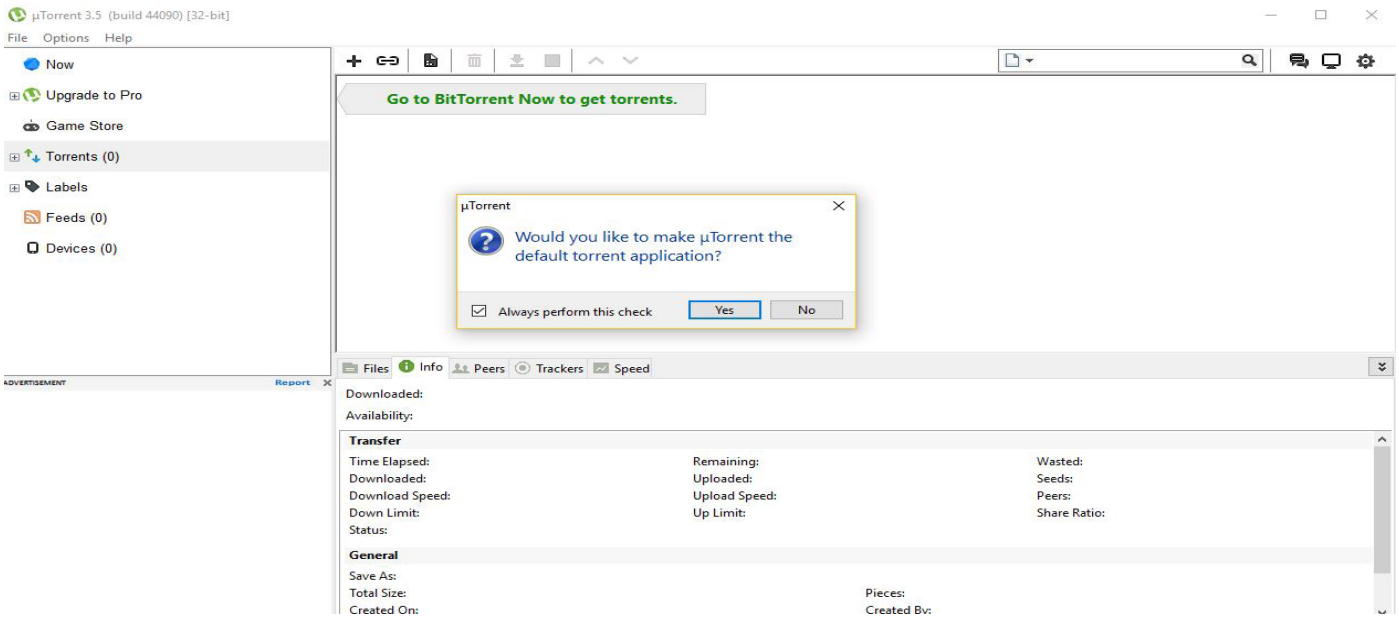
8. *Click on Decline here.* **Clicking on Decline does not void the installation, but declares that you do not want the Yahoo software.**



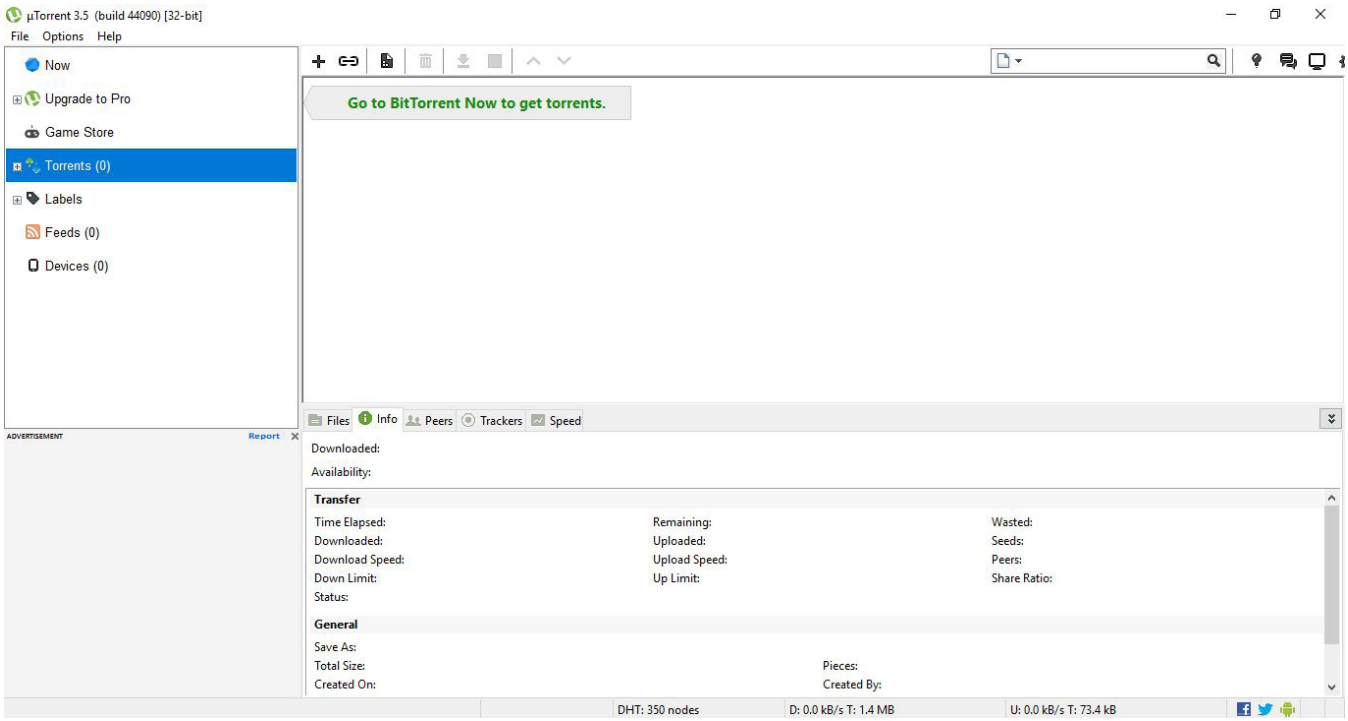
9. You will see a screen similar to the screen shown below before the uTorrent opens up automatically.



10. The uTorrent software home screen is indicated below. It will ask you if you want to make uTorrent the default program for your torrent downloads. Uncheck **Always perform this check** and click on **Yes**.

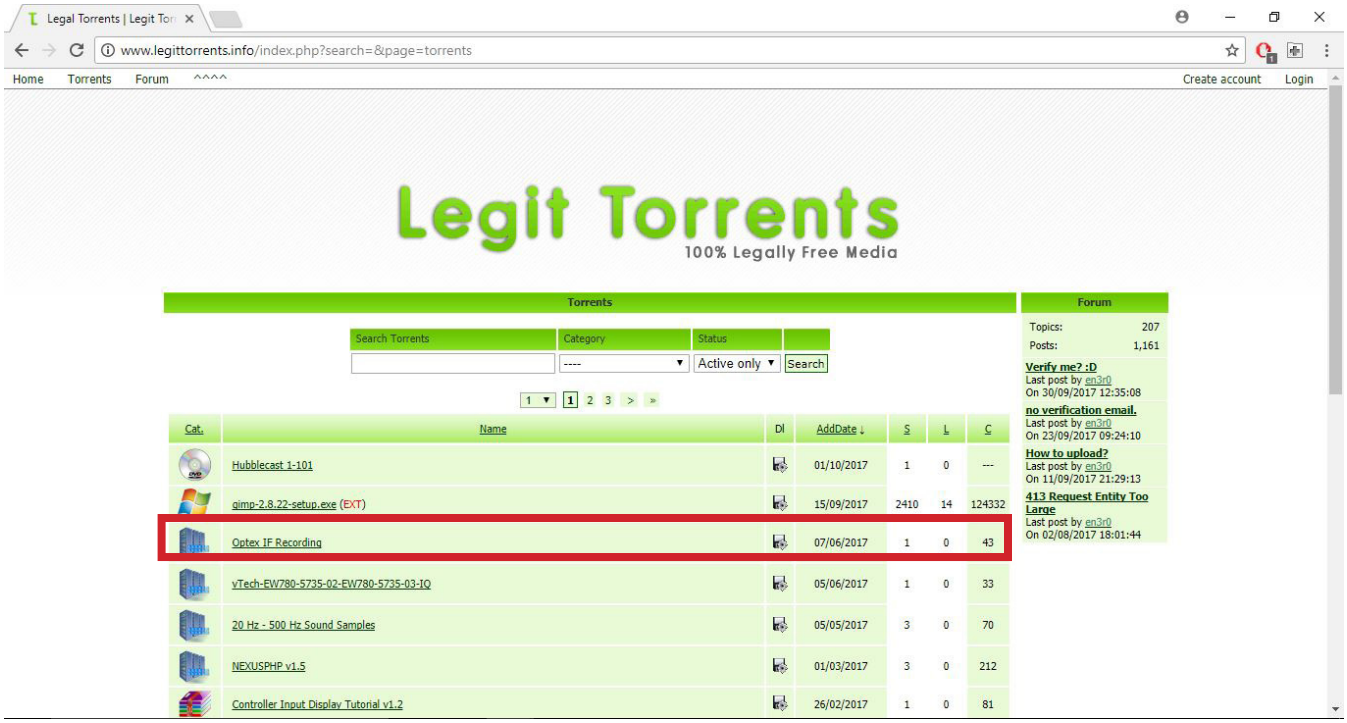


11. This is the home screen for uTorrent. Even if you close uTorrent, it will keep running in the background, and can only be closed from the **System Tray**, at the bottom right of your screen. By default, uTorrent will start when Windows starts.

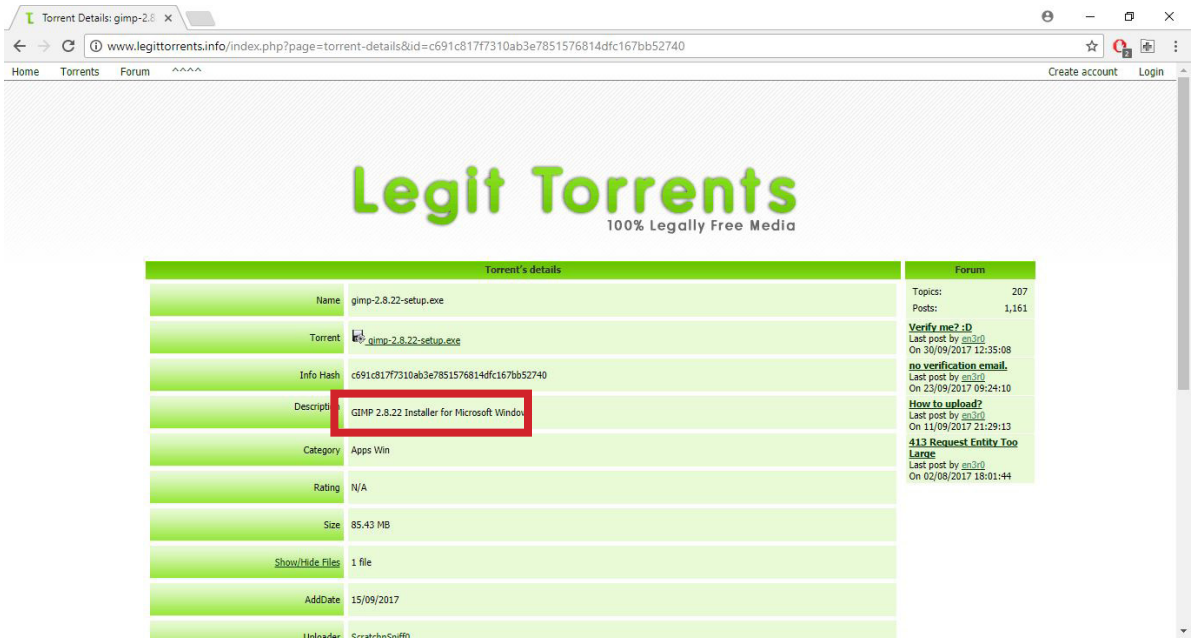


Starting The Torrent Download

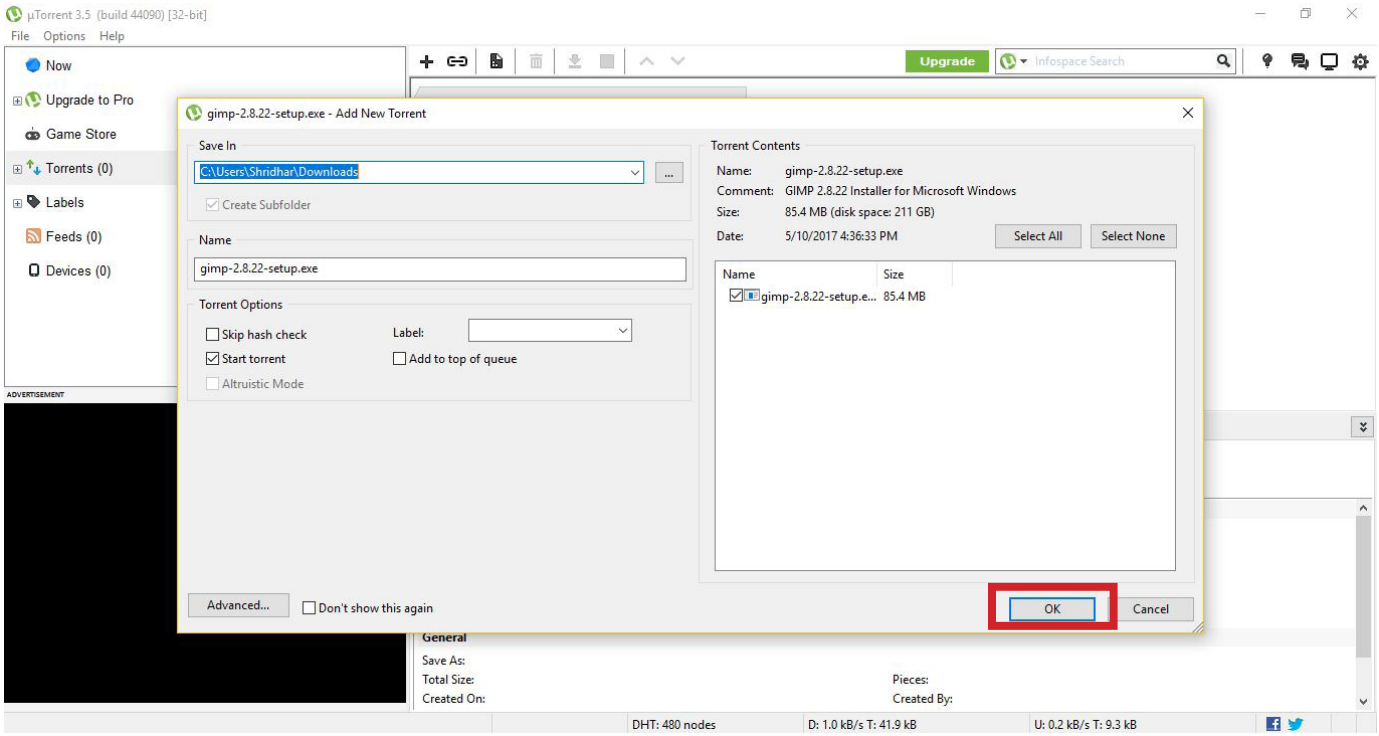
1. Start any torrent you want, and track its progress on the torrent software.
2. Navigate to any legal torrent website (on our broswer, Google Chrome for this document) that has been listed on the first page, *as indicated below*. For the purposes of this document, we will look at Legit Torrents, located at legittorrents.info.



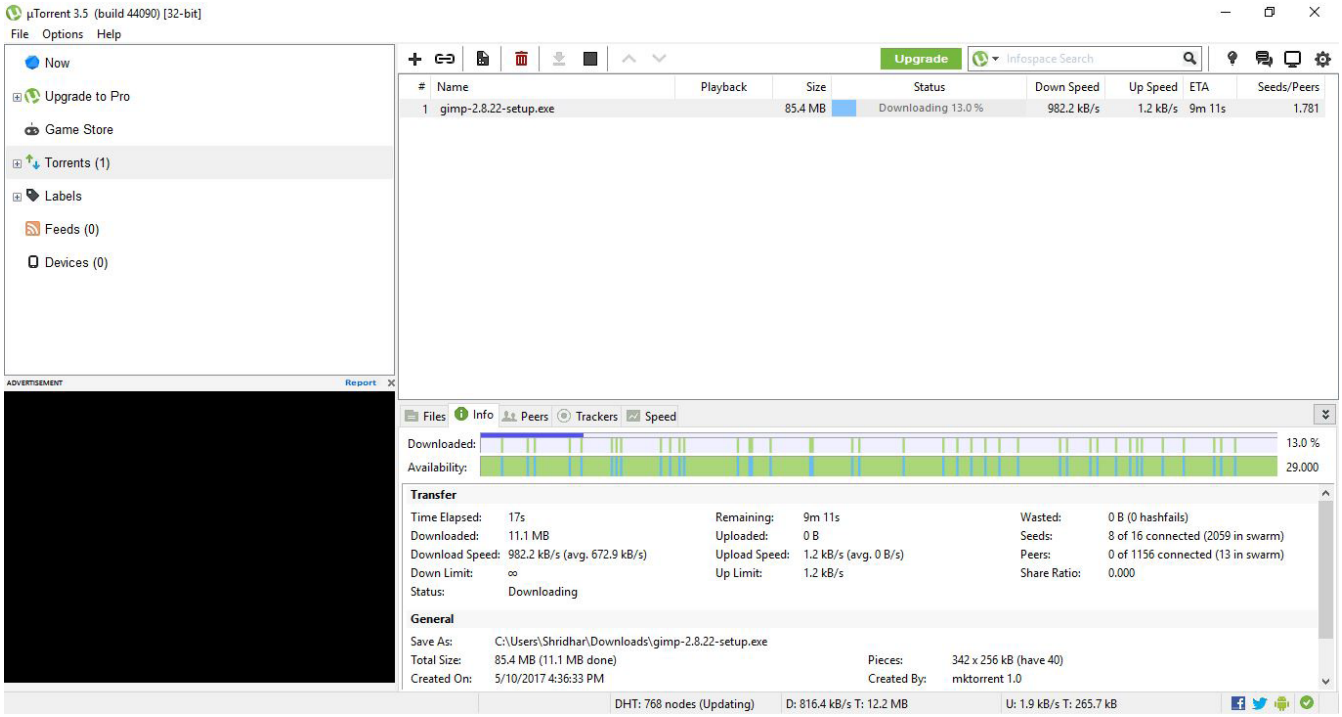
3. For the purposes of this demonstration, select the file highlighted above from among the options we have at hand.
4. Select GIMP, which is a free file editor for Windows, and also has a high seed count.
5. Clicking on the file under **Name** will redirect the user to the page shown below.



6. Click on the the file indicated by the red rectangle in the previous image and then click on the torrent file that appears in the bottom left corner of the broswer. This will open up your uTorrent home screen with the **Add New Torrent** window, *as shown below.*



7. Change the location of the download by changing the **Save In** option or any option that you want to change, and then click on the **OK** button, highlighted in the image above. This will result in the image below.



The torrent downloads much faster if there's more seeds; the high download rate is indicated in the image above. You can analyze more things if you delve into options within the torrent software.